



*The yogic concept of equanimity teaches us to handle **change** and challenges with **grace**.*

Q HOW DOES YOGA AFFECT

HOW WE AGE?

According to experts, yoga has the following benefits that support healthy aging:

- builds muscle strength to counteract the natural skeletal atrophy that happens with aging
- improves flexibility to prevent the loss of range of motion
- improves dynamic and static balance, reducing your risk of falling
- improves mental and physical agility so you can react faster.

Yoga improves strength, flexibility, balance, and agility in both physical and mental realms. Together, all of this may help improve your healthspan—the number of years you live without illness.



Did you know?

IN 2050, **ONE FIFTH** OF THE WORLD'S POPULATION WILL BE **AGE 60** OR OVER. THIS MAKES IT **MORE IMPORTANT** THAN EVER TO PREPARE OUR BODIES FOR **HEALTHY AGING** WITH PRACTICES SUCH AS YOGA.

MYTH-BUSTER

I'm too old to practice yoga.

Studies of yoga and older adults have shown improvements in flexibility, strength, balance, and functional activities, such as getting up from a chair. Yoga is also highly customizable. You can practice simple breathwork and adapt any asana, for example by using a chair, blocks, or blankets.

Q CAN YOGA HELP ME KEEP MY INDEPENDENCE?

Yes. Practicing yoga can help you maintain independence by preserving functional abilities so you can perform daily activities and continue doing what you love. Applying the philosophy of yoga to your life can also help you find purpose and meaning, which contributes to independence and well-being. For example, the yogic concept of equanimity (mental calmness) teaches us to handle change and challenges with grace.

Just **8** weeks of mindfulness practice could slow brain changes associated with aging.